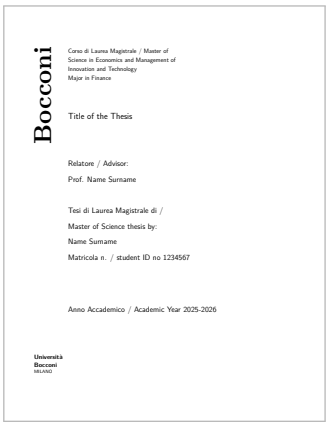
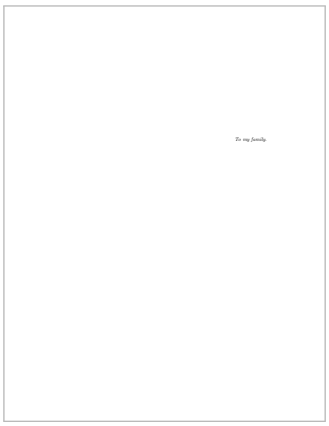
academicthesis

Università Bocconi

User and developer guide



Simil front page



Dedication page

Luca Salvatore

academicthesis v0.2.0 • October 2026

Contents

I User guide **3**

1 What this package does **4**
1.1 Two ways to start a thesis . . . 4
1.2 What you get . . . 4
1.3 How it is organised . . . 5

2 Installing and compiling **6**
2.1 Requirements . . . 6
2.2 The files you need . . . 6
2.3 Three ways to set it up . . . 6
2.4 Compiling . . . 7

3 Writing your thesis **8**
3.1 The shape of a thesis file . . . 8
3.2 Class options . . . 9
3.3 The data of your thesis . . . 9
3.4 Logos: `\bocconithesissetup` . . . 10
3.5 After the opening pages . . . 10

4 Front matter and bibliography **11**
4.1 Abstract, originality, acknowledgements, dedication . . . 11
4.2 Bibliography . . . 11

5 Complete examples **13**
5.1 With the official front page (default) . . . 13
5.2 With the simil front page . . . 13

6 Troubleshooting **15**

II Developer guide **16**

7 How the core works **17**
7.1 Design principles . . . 17
7.2 Files . . . 18
7.3 What happens when a thesis is compiled . . . 19
7.4 The early configuration file . . . 19
7.5 Thesis data . . . 20
7.6 Registries . . . 21
7.7 Strings and languages . . . 21
7.8 Front matter, second page, page styles . . . 22
7.9 Two rules for writing layout code . . . 22
7.10 Search path in the repository . . . 22
7.11 Messages . . . 23

7.12 Adding a university, in short . . . 23

8 The Bocconi package **24**
8.1 Files . . . 24
8.2 The early configuration . . . 24
8.3 The package . . . 25
8.4 The opening pages . . . 25
8.5 Strings . . . 26
8.6 Common changes . . . 26

Licence and credits **27**

Part I

User guide

For students writing a Bocconi bachelor's or master's thesis: what the class does, how to set it up, every option and command available, and complete examples.

Chapter 1

What this package does

A Bocconi thesis opens with an official front page that the university adds to the bound copy, followed by a dedication page. The rest of the thesis is up to the student. academicthesis prepares those opening pages correctly, and gives the rest of the thesis a clean, consistent layout:

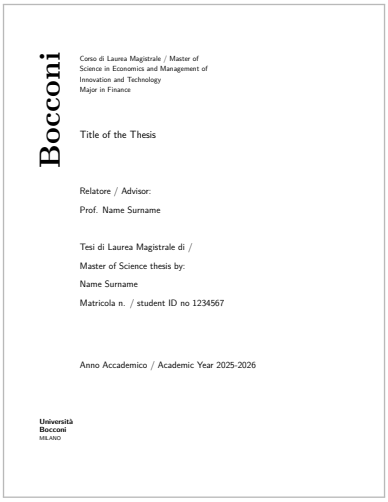
```
\documentclass[university=bocconi, master]{academicthesis}
```

1.1 Two ways to start a thesis

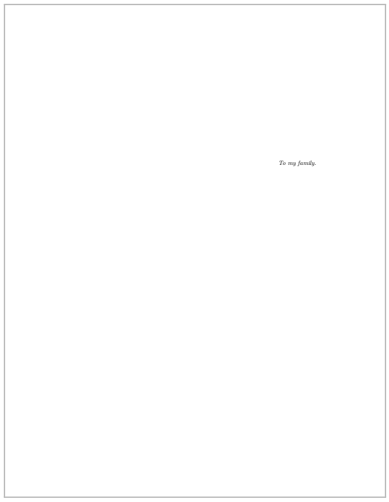
The class option `simil_frontpages` chooses between them.

	`simil_frontpages=false` (default)	`simil_frontpages=true`
Page 1	blank: the official front page goes here	the *simil* front page, printed by the class
Page 2	blank	blank (back of the front page)
Page 3	the dedication, or blank	the dedication, or blank
Page 4	blank (back of the dedication)	blank (back of the dedication)
Required fields	none	title, candidate, degree, supervisor(s), student ID, academic year

"Simil" means a printed likeness of the official front page: useful for a draft, a digital copy or a submission where the official page is not added by the university.



Simil front page (page 1)



Dedication page (page 3)

1.2 What you get

- **The opening pages** in the right order, with blank backs, numbered with letters so that they never clash with the front-matter page numbers.

- **The simil front page**, bilingual like the official one (“Relatore / Advisor”, “Anno Accademico / Academic Year”), with the degree, major, title, advisor(s), candidate and student ID.
- **Front-matter blocks**: abstract, statement of originality, acknowledgements and dedication, in English, Italian or French.
- **Checks** when the simil front page is printed: a missing field stops compilation with a message naming it.

1.3 How it is organised

The class has a core shared by every university and one package per university. With `university=bocconi` the core loads the Bocconi package by itself. Part II of this guide explains the code.

Chapter 2

Installing and compiling

2.1 Requirements

- A recent TeX distribution: TeX Live or MacTeX 2023 or later, or an up-to-date MiKTeX. The class is written in LaTeX3 and needs a modern LaTeX kernel.
- **pdfLaTeX** is the reference engine, used by all the examples in this guide. XeLaTeX and LuaLaTeX are also accepted (the class then loads fontspec).
- For the bibliography, biblatex and biber, both part of every full TeX distribution. Without them the class falls back to natbib and BibTeX (Section 4.2).

2.2 The files you need

academicthesis is a collection of small packages that load one another *by name*. For a Bocconi thesis you need only these:

Files	Role
`core/academicthesis.cls`, `core/academicthesis-kernel.sty`	The core class, shared by every university.
`languages/academicthesis-<language>.ldf`	The words printed on the pages, one file per language (English, Italian, French).
`universities/bocconi/*`	The Bocconi package: its layout, labels and logos.

The other folders of `universities/` belong to other universities and can be left out.

2.3 Three ways to set it up

1. **Inside the repository.** Copy the Bocconi showcase in `showcases/` and keep its first line,

   ```
   \input{academicthesis-repo-paths}
   ```

   which tells LaTeX where the package folders are. Then compile with any editor, or from a terminal with `latexmk`.
2. **Next to your thesis.** Copy the files listed above into the folder of your thesis (without sub-folders) and delete the `\input{academicthesis-repo-paths}` line. This is also how to use the class on Overleaf: upload the files to the project.
3. **Installed in your personal TeX tree**, for example `~/Library/texmf/tex/latex/academicthesis/` on macOS or `~/texmf/tex/latex/academicthesis/` on Linux. Every document on the computer can then use the class, with no extra line.

Editors

Texifier/Texpad, TeXShop, TeXstudio, VS Code (LaTeX Workshop) and Overleaf all work. In Texifier/Texpad, set the typesetter to *TeX Live (pdfLaTeX)*: its built-in engine is too old for this class.

2.4 Compiling

Run pdfLaTeX twice (for the table of contents and cross-references), with biber between the two runs when the thesis has a bibliography. `latexmk` does all of this by itself:

```
latexmk -pdf my-thesis.tex
```

Chapter 3

Writing your thesis

3.1 The shape of a thesis file

```
\documentclass[university=bocconi, master, simil_frontpages=true,
               language=english, twoside]{academicthesis}

\thesissetup{
  degree       = {Economics and Management of Innovation and Technology},
  major        = {Major in Finance},          % optional
  title        = {Title of the Thesis},
  supervisor   = {Prof. Name Surname},
  candidate    = {Name Surname},
  idnumber     = {1234567},
  academicyear = {2025-2026},
  dedication   = {To my family.},             % optional, page 3
}
\addbibresource{references.bib}

\begin{document}
\frontpage                          % pages 1-4

\frontmatter
\begin{abstractthesis}
  The abstract.
\end{abstractthesis}
\tableofcontents

\mainmatter
\chapter{Introduction}
...
\printbibliography

\backmatter
\begin{acknowledgements}
  Thanks to ...
\end{acknowledgements}
\end{document}
```

3.2 Class options

Option	Values	Meaning
`university`	`bocconi`	Selects the Bocconi package. Required.
degree	`bachelor`, `master`	Written on its own. Default: `bachelor`.
`simil_frontpages`	`true`, `false`	Print the simil front page (`true`) or leave two blank pages for the official one (`false`, the default). Written alone, it means `true`. `simil_frontpage` (singular) is accepted too.
`language`	`english`, `italian`, `french`	Language of the front-matter headings and hyphenation. The front page is bilingual whatever the language. Default: `english`.
`other-languages`	e.g. `{italian}`	Other languages used by single blocks (Section 4.1).
`biblatex-options`	e.g. `{style=apa}`	Options for biblatex (Section 4.2).
anything else	`twoside`, `12pt`, ...	Passed to the book class.

Bocconi has a single layout, so the `format` option is not used, and no examination or copyright page is printed.

3.3 The data of your thesis

All the data is given with `\thesissetup` in the preamble. With `simil_frontpages=false` nothing is required: only `dedication` is used.

Key	Printed on the simil front page as	With simil
`degree`	After "Corso di Laurea Triennale / Bachelor of Science in" (master: "Corso di Laurea Magistrale / Master of Science in")	**required**
`major`	Under the degree, as written	optional
`title`	Title	**required**
`subtitle`	Under the title	optional
`supervisor` / `supervisors`	Under "Relatore / Advisor" (plural: "Relatori / Advisors")	**required**
`cosupervisor` / `cosupervisors`	Under "Correlatore / Co-advisor"	optional
`candidate`	Under "Tesi di Laurea Magistrale di / Master of Science thesis by"	**required**
`idnumber`	"Matricola n. / student ID no"	**required**
`academicyear`	"Anno Accademico / Academic Year"	**required**
`dedication`	Page 3, right-aligned italic (both modes)	optional

Writing the values

- `degree` is written without "Bachelor of Science in", which the page adds.
- `supervisor` takes one name; `supervisors` takes several, separated by commas, and the label becomes plural.
- Names are printed as written; the official page uses capitals, e.g. `{Prof. NAME SURNAME}`, if you want to match it.

3.4 Logos: \bocconithesissetup

The simil front page carries two logos: the vertical "Bocconi" wordmark on the left and the "Università Bocconi Milano" logo at the bottom. The logo files are **not shipped** with the package: put the official files (PDF or PNG) next to your thesis, and the page uses them. When a file is missing, the page draws a text stand-in in the same place, as in the preview above.

Key	Default	Effect
wordmark-file	bocconiwordmark	The vertical wordmark, 6.6 cm high.
logo-file	logobocconi	The bottom logo, 4.3 cm wide.

```
\bocconithesissetup{wordmark-file = bocconi-vertical,
                    logo-file     = bocconi-logo}
```

3.5 After the opening pages

From \frontmatter on, the thesis uses the core layout of the class (the same as LUISS): chapter openings, running headers and the front-matter blocks of Chapter 4. A dedication can be given either with dedication in \thesissetup (page 3) or with the \dedication command later.

Chapter 4

Front matter and bibliography

4.1 Abstract, originality, acknowledgements, dedication

The core class provides four front-matter blocks. They are written the same way at every university; the Bocconi package only sets their look.

Block	Options	Default heading (English)
`\begin{abstractthesis}`	`language`, `keywords`, `title`	Abstract
`\begin{originality}`	`language`, `title`	Statement of Originality
`\begin{acknowledgements}`	`language`, `title`	Acknowledgments
`\dedication[...]{text}`	`language`	none: the text alone on its page

- `language=` writes the block in another language: its heading, the "Keywords" label and the hyphenation follow that language. Without it, the block uses the main language of the thesis. For correct hyphenation, also list the language in the `other-languages` class option, e.g. `other-languages={italian}`; otherwise a warning reminds you.
- `keywords=` prints a list of keywords after the abstract.
- `title=` replaces the default heading.

Abstracts, statements of originality and acknowledgements are listed in the table of contents. An English abstract followed by an Italian one:

```
\begin{abstractthesis}[keywords = {corporate finance, valuation}]
  The English abstract.
\end{abstractthesis}
\begin{abstractthesis}[language = italian,
                       keywords = {finanza aziendale, valutazione}]
  L'abstract in italiano.
\end{abstractthesis}
\dedication{To my family.}
```

4.2 Bibliography

The class loads biblatex with biber for you; do not load biblatex again in your preamble. Its style is, in order of priority: the options you give with the class option `biblatex-options`; the university's default (Bocconi sets none, so the numeric style applies); otherwise a numeric style.

```
\documentclass[..., biblatex-options={style=apa}]{academicthesis}
\addbibresource{references.bib}   % in the preamble
...
\printbibliography                % where the bibliography goes
```

If biblatex is not installed, the class warns and uses natbib with BibTeX behind the same two

commands, so the thesis still compiles.

Chapter 5

Complete examples

5.1 With the official front page (default)

```
\documentclass[university=bocconi, bachelor, language=english,
               twoside]{academicthesis}

\thesissetup{
  dedication = {To my family.},     % page 3; leave it out for a blank page
}

\begin{document}
\frontpage                          % blank, blank, dedication, blank
\frontmatter
\begin{abstractthesis}
  The abstract.
\end{abstractthesis}
\tableofcontents
\mainmatter
\chapter{Introduction}
...
\backmatter
\begin{acknowledgements}
  Thanks to ...
\end{acknowledgements}
\end{document}
```

5.2 With the simil front page

```
\documentclass[university=bocconi, master, simil_frontpages=true,
               language=english, twoside,
               other-languages={italian}]{academicthesis}

\thesissetup{
  degree       = {Economics and Management of Innovation and Technology},
  major        = {Major in Finance},
  title        = {Title of the Thesis},
  supervisor   = {Prof. Name Surname},
  candidate    = {Name Surname},
  idnumber     = {1234567},
  academicyear = {2025-2026},
  dedication   = {To my family.},
}
\addbibresource{references.bib}

\begin{document}
\frontpage
\frontmatter
```

```
\begin{abstractthesis}[keywords = {first, second}]
  The abstract.
\end{abstractthesis}
\begin{abstractthesis}[language = italian, keywords = {primo, secondo}]
  L'abstract in italiano.
\end{abstractthesis}
\tableofcontents
\mainmatter
\chapter{Introduction}
...
\printbibliography
\end{document}
```

Complete, compilable versions: `showcases/example-bocconi-bachelor.tex` and `showcases/example-bocconi-simil.tex`.

Chapter 6

Troubleshooting

Message (abridged)	Cause	Fix
Missing required thesis metadata: '*key*'	`simil_frontpages=true` and a field of the page is missing	Add it; the message shows an example. See Section 3.3.
simil_frontpages must be true or false	Another value, e.g. `yes`	Write `true` or `false`.
No front page registered for university 'bocconi', degree 'phd'	The `phd` degree	Bocconi offers `bachelor` and `master`.
University 'bocconi' does not offer formats	A `format` option	Remove it.
Text "Bocconi" instead of the logo	Logo files not found	Put the official files next to the thesis, or name them with `\bocconithesissetup`.
File 'academicthesis.cls' not found	LaTeX cannot see the class files	Keep the line that inputs `academicthesis-repo-paths`, or copy the files next to the thesis (Chapter 2).
Warning: 'italian' ... was not loaded by babel	A block with `language=italian`	Add `italian` to the `other-languages` option.

Quick reference

```
\documentclass[university=bocconi, bachelor|master,
               simil_frontpages=true|false,
               language=english|italian|french]{academicthesis}
\bocconithesissetup{wordmark-file=..., logo-file=...}
% simil=false: nothing required; dedication optional
% simil=true:  degree title supervisor(s) candidate idnumber academicyear
%              (major, subtitle, cosupervisor(s), dedication optional)
\frontpage
\begin{abstractthesis}[language=..., keywords=..., title=...]
  ... \end{abstractthesis}
\begin{acknowledgements}[language=..., title=...]
  ... \end{acknowledgements}
```

Part II

Developer guide

For those who maintain or extend the code: first how the shared core works, then how the Bocconi package is built on it.

Chapter 7

How the core works

This chapter describes the part of the code that every university shares. The next chapter builds on it to explain the Bocconi package. The reader is assumed to know LaTeX 2ε package writing; LaTeX3 (expl3) names are explained where they matter.

7.1 Design principles

The core knows no university. `academicthesis.cls` never mentions LUISS, Politecnico di Milano or Bocconi. A university package plugs into a small number of *registries* (front pages, required fields, bibliography defaults) and *declarations* (base class, formats, second page, extra languages, extra class options) that the core consults at the right moment.

A university knows only the core. A university package uses the kernel's public commands and never another university's code, so each one can be versioned, shipped and installed on its own.

Files are found by name, never by folder. Every `\LoadClass`, `\RequirePackage`, `\input` and `\includegraphics` names a file, not a path. Once installed in a TeX tree, kpathsea finds each file whatever package shipped it; in the repository, the search path is extended instead of changing the code (Section 7.10).

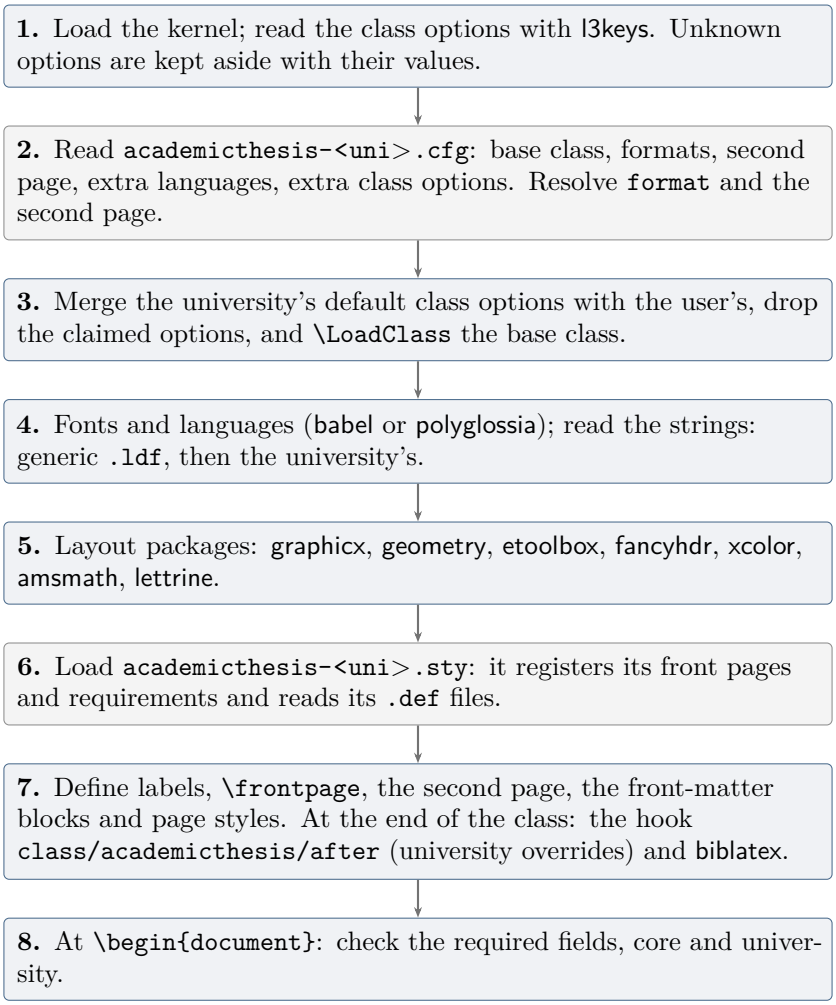
One data store, one vocabulary. All thesis data lives in a single property list with the same key names at every university. Universities change *wording* through string files, not key names.

Logic in LaTeX3, typesetting in LaTeX 2ε. Option handling, registries and validation are written in expl3; everything that puts text on the page is written in ordinary LaTeX syntax, where spaces and blank lines behave as usual (Section 7.9).

7.2 Files

File	Role
`core/academicthesis.cls`	The class: options, base class, fonts and languages, bibliography, loading the university, labels, `\frontpage`, second page, front-matter blocks, page styles, validation.
`core/academicthesis-kernel.sty`	The shared API: messages, metadata store, `\thesissetup`, lists, registries, early-configuration commands, university loader, string store. Loaded first, by the class.
`languages/academicthesis-<lang>.ldf`	Generic strings for one language (`\ProvideThesisString` calls only).
`universities/<uni>/academicthesis-<uni>.cfg`	Early configuration, read *before* the base class is loaded.
`universities/<uni>/academicthesis-<uni>.sty`	The university package proper.
`universities/<uni>/academicthesis-<uni>-*.def`	Layout code in normal LaTeX syntax, read by the `.sty`.
`universities/<uni>/academicthesis-<uni>-<lang>.ldf`	Optional: the university's wording of core strings, and its own strings.
`showcases/academicthesis-repo-paths.tex`	Lets the examples find the repository folders (not part of any package).

7.3 What happens when a thesis is compiled



Grey steps are where the university's own files run. Two consequences matter when writing a university package:

- The `.cfg` runs before `\LoadClass`: it may only use the early-configuration commands (Section 7.4) and expl3 logic, not packages or document commands.
- The `.sty` runs *before* the core defines its labels, blocks and page styles (step 7). To change one of those, a university wraps its redefinition in the hook that LaTeX runs once the class has finished:

```
\AddToHook{class/academicthesis/after}{%
  \RenewDocumentCommand\thesiskeywords{mm}{...}}
```

7.4 The early configuration file

`academicthesis-<uni>.cfg` is read with expl3 syntax on (spaces are ignored; write `~` for a space). Its commands concern only the active university, so they take no university argument.

Command	Meaning
`\DeclareThesisBaseClass {<class>}{<options>}`	Base class (book, article, ...) and its default options. A default is dropped when the user chose another option of the same group: `11pt` beats a default `12pt`, `oneside` beats `twoside`. Default: book with no options.
`\DeclareThesisFormats {<list>}{<default>}`	The values accepted by `format=`. Resolved at once, so the rest of the file can branch on `\g__academicthesis_format_tl`. A university that declares none rejects `format=`.
`\DeclareThesisSecondPage {true|false}`	Default for the second page (examination commission and copyright). The user can override it with `secondpage` / `no-secondpage`. Default: `true`.
`\DeclareThesisOtherLanguages {<list>}`	Languages always loaded with babel, besides the main one.
`\DeclareThesisClassOption {<name>}{<default>}`	Claims a `\documentclass` option for the university; it is no longer passed to the base class. `name` alone means `true`. Read it with `\academicthesis_class_option:n{<name>}` or, in normal syntax, `\thesisclassoption{<name>}`.
`\DeclareThesisCoreRequirements {true|false}`	Whether the core checks its own required fields (title, candidate, academic year, degree, supervisors). The university's requirements are checked either way. Default: `true`.

7.5 Thesis data

7.5.1 The store

All data given with `\thesissetup` goes into one global property list. `\thesissetup` is a thin l3keys front-end: each key writes one entry.

expl3 (in .sty/.cfg)	Effect
`\academicthesis_meta_set:nn {key}{value}`	Store a value.
`\academicthesis_meta_get:n {key}`	The value (expandable; empty when missing).
`\academicthesis_meta_if_empty:nTF`	Test for an empty or missing value (also `p`, `T`, `F`).
`\academicthesis_list_set:nn`, `\_set_csv:nn`, `\_add:nn`	Set a list to one item, to comma-separated items, or append one.
`\academicthesis_list_count:n`, `\academicthesis_list_if_empty:nTF`	Number of items; emptiness test.

Normal syntax (in .def)	Effect
\thesismeta {key}	The value (expandable).
\IfThesisMetaEmptyTF {key}{empty}{not empty}	Branch on a value.
\academicthesislist [sep]{list}	Typeset a list; default separator \\.
\thesislistcount {list}, \IfThesisListEmptyTF	Count items; branch on emptiness.
\IfThesisDegreeTF {bachelor|master|phd}{yes}{no}	Branch on the degree.
\thesisclassoption {name}	Value of a claimed class option.

The standard keys are title, subtitle, candidate, idnumber, degree, chair, department, major, phdtitle, cycle, academicyear, copyyear, examdate, authoremail, website, dedication, abstract, keywords, coordinator and gender, plus the lists supervisors, cosupervisors, examiners and tutors (each with a singular key that sets one item without splitting at commas). A university may store keys of its own with \academicthesis_meta_set:nn; the core never reads them.

7.5.2 Validation

At \begin{document} the core checks its own fields (unless switched off in the .cfg) and then every entry registered with

```
\DeclareThesisRequirement{<uni>}{<boolean>}{<key>}{<example>}
```

whose university is the active one and whose expl3 boolean is true: \c_true_bool (always), \g__academicthesis_bachelor_bool, _master_bool or _phd_bool. A missing field raises the error *Missing required thesis metadata: '<key>'*, whose help text shows <example>.

7.6 Registries

Command	Meaning
\DeclareThesisFrontPage {<uni>}{<degree>}{<cs>}	\frontpage looks up <uni>.<degree> and runs <cs>; if nothing is registered, it raises *No front page registered*. The command typesets its own page(s).
\DeclareThesisRequirement {<uni>}{<bool>}{<key>}{<ex>}	A required field (above).
\DeclareThesisBibDefaults {<uni>}{<options>}	biblatex options used when the user gives no biblatex-options.

7.7 Strings and languages

Every printed word comes from a string store, one per language, filled by \ProvideThesisString{<key>}{<text>}. For each language the kernel reads academicthesis-<lang>.ldf and then, if it exists, academicthesis-<uni>-<lang>.ldf.

A university file reuses the core keys to change the wording (for instance `SupervisorLabel`) and may add keys of its own.

`\thesisstring{<key>}` prints a string in the language currently selected for strings: the main language, or the one a block switched to with `language=`. It falls back to the main language, then to the key name, so a missing translation never stops compilation.

The labels `\authorlabel`, `\supervisorlabel` and `\cosupervisorlabel` choose the singular or plural string from the length of the list, and the female form of the candidate label from `gender`.

7.8 Front matter, second page, page styles

- `\frontpage` dispatches to the registered front page, then prints the second page if it is on.
- `abstractthesis`, `originality`, `acknowledgements` and `\dedication` all go through one option parser (`language`, `title`, `keywords`). Headings use `\thesisfrontchapter`, which writes `\chapter*` or `\section*` depending on whether the base class has chapters, and adds the table-of-contents entry.
- Universities can restyle without touching the parser: `\thesiskeywords{<label>}{<keywords>}` prints the keywords; `\thesisacknowledgementsbegin{<heading>}` and `\thesisacknowledgementsend` frame the acknowledgements.
- The core defines the page styles `Thesis`, `acknowledgments` and `plain`; `\frontmatter` switches to `plain` and `\mainmatter` to `Thesis`. Under a base class without chapters, the core supplies light versions of `\frontmatter`, `\mainmatter` and `\backmatter`.

7.9 Two rules for writing layout code

Typeset in normal syntax. Under `\ExplSyntaxOn` spaces are ignored and blank lines do not end paragraphs, which silently breaks any text. University packages therefore keep their expl3 code in the `.sty` and put pages in `.def` files read with the document catcodes:

```
\cs_new_protected:Npn \__myuni_input_layout:n #1
  {
    \cctab_begin:N \c_document_cctab   % no group: definitions survive
      \file_input:n { academicthesis-myuni-#1.def }
    \cctab_end:
  }
```

Never load a package from a `.def` file. When a package loaded from there ends, LaTeX restores the syntax of the class that is loading everything, expl3, and every space that follows is lost. The `.sty` loads the packages before reading the `.def`.

7.10 Search path in the repository

Inside the repository the files sit in sub-folders, which TeX does not search. Two mechanisms make them visible without any path in the code:

- **latexmk**: the root `latexmkrc` adds `core//`, `languages//` and `universities//` to `TEXINPUTS` (the trailing `//` also searches sub-folders).

- **Any editor**: `showcases/academicthesis-repo-paths.tex`, input before `\documentclass`, extends LaTeX's `\input@path` with the folders. `\input@path` does not search sub-folders, so it lists each university folder; a new university needs a line there.

7.11 Messages

All messages use the expl3 message module `academicthesis`, so they read *Class academicthesis Error* and carry a help text.

Name	When
`missing-metadata`	A required field is empty.
`missing-frontpage`	No front page registered for the university and degree.
`unknown-university`	No `academicthesis-<uni>.sty` found.
`missing-config`	The `.sty` exists but the `.cfg` does not.
`unknown-format`, `no-formats`	A `format` the university does not declare, or any `format` at a university with none.
`missing-language`	No `.ldf` for the chosen language (falls back to English).
`bibliography-fallback`	biblatex unavailable (warning).

A university defines its own messages in the same module with `\msg_new:nnnn{academicthesis}{<uni>-<name>}{...}{...}`.

7.12 Adding a university, in short

1. Create `universities/<uni>/` with `academicthesis-<uni>.cfg` (at least `\DeclareThesisBaseClass`).
2. Write `academicthesis-<uni>.sty`: `\RequirePackage {academicthesis-kernel}`, setup keys, packages, requirements, then read the `.def` files.
3. In each `.def`, define the front page and register it with `\DeclareThesisFrontPage` for each degree offered.
4. Add `academicthesis-<uni>-<lang>.ldf` files for its wording.
5. Add its folder to `showcases/academicthesis-repo-paths.tex` and a showcase.

Nothing in `core/`, `languages/` or another university changes.

Chapter 8

The Bocconi package

8.1 Files

File	Role
`academicthesis-bocconi.cfg`	Base class, the `simil_frontpages` class option, no second page, core requirements only with the simil page.
`academicthesis-bocconi.sty`	`\bocconithesissetup`, the student ID requirement, eso-pic, reading the opening pages.
`academicthesis-bocconi-frontpages.def`	The opening pages, bachelor and master, in normal syntax.
`academicthesis-bocconi-english.ldf`, `-italian.ldf`	The bilingual labels of the front page (identical in both files).

8.2 The early configuration

The Bocconi package is the example of a university *class option*:

```
\DeclareThesisBaseClass { book } { }
\DeclareThesisClassOption { simil_frontpages } { false }
\DeclareThesisClassOption { simil_frontpage }  { false }   % alias

\bool_new:N \g__bocconi_simil_bool
\clist_map_inline:nn { simil_frontpages , simil_frontpage }
  {
    \str_case_e:nnF { \academicthesis_class_option:n { #1 } }
      {
        { true }  { \bool_gset_true:N \g__bocconi_simil_bool }
        { false } { }
      }
      { \msg_error:nne { academicthesis } { bocconi-simil-value } {...} }
  }

\DeclareThesisSecondPage { false }
\bool_if:NF \g__bocconi_simil_bool
  { \DeclareThesisCoreRequirements { false } }
```

`\DeclareThesisClassOption` takes the option away from the book class (which would otherwise warn about an unused option) and records its value. Without the simil page nothing is printed from the data, so the core's own checks are switched off.

8.3 The package

1. `\ifbocconi@simil` mirrors `\g__bocconi_simil_bool` for the layout file.
2. `\bocconithesissetup` sets `wordmark-file` and `logo-file` (key family `academicthesis-bocconi/layout`); `\bocconi@wordmarkfile` and `\bocconi@logofile` hand them to the layout.
3. With the simil page, `idnumber` is added to the core requirements, and eso-pic is loaded for the logos.
4. `academicthesis-bocconi-frontpages.def` is read with the document catcodes.

8.4 The opening pages

Command	Role
`\bocconi@frontpage`	Registered for `bachelor` and `master`. Switches page numbering to letters (`\pagenumbering{Alph}`), then prints the simil page and its blank back, or two blank pages, then the dedication page.
`\bocconi@similfrontpage`	The simil page: a local `\newgeometry` (left 4.3 cm, right 4.1 cm, top 2.8 cm, bottom 3 cm), sans serif, the logos added with `\AddToShipoutPicture*`.
`\bocconi@pagelogos`	Places the wordmark and the bottom logo at positions measured on the official A4 page.
`\bocconi@graphic{file}{opts}{stand-in}`	Includes `file.pdf` or `file.png` if it exists, otherwise typesets the stand-in.
`\bocconi@dedicationpage`	The dedication (from `dedication`) or an empty page, then a blank back.
`\bocconi@degreecourse`, `\bocconi@thesisby`	The bachelor or master wording, from `\IfThesisDegreeTF`.
`\bocconi@coursefont`, `\bocconi@titlefont`, `\bocconi@bodyfont`	Sizes measured on the official page (12/17, 17/20, 15/30 pt).
`\bocconi@gapA`, `\bocconi@gapB`, `\bocconi@gapC`	The three vertical gaps of the page.

```
\newcommand\bocconi@frontpage{%
  \pagenumbering{Alph}%
  \ifbocconi@simil
    \bocconi@similfrontpage
    \bocconi@emptypage % its blank back
  \else
    \bocconi@emptypage
    \bocconi@emptypage
  \fi
  \bocconi@dedicationpage}
\DeclareThesisFrontPage{bocconi}{bachelor}{\bocconi@frontpage}
\DeclareThesisFrontPage{bocconi}{master}{\bocconi@frontpage}
```

8.5 Strings

The official page is bilingual, so both `.ldf` files hold the same Italian / English text. They redefine the core keys `SupervisorLabel(s)`, `CoSupervisorLabel(s)`, `IDNumber` and `AcademicYear`, and add `BocconiBachelorCourse`, `BocconiMasterCourse`, `BocconiBachelorThesisBy` and `BocconiMasterThesisBy`.

8.6 Common changes

To change…	**Edit…**
spacing or sizes of the simil page	`\bocconi@gapA`–`\bocconi@gapC` and the font commands in the `.def`.
logo positions or sizes	`\bocconi@pagelogos`.
the order of the opening pages	`\bocconi@frontpage`.
the wording	both `.ldf` files.
required fields	the `.cfg` (core checks) and the `.sty` (student ID).

Licence and credits

academicthesis is released under the LaTeX Project Public Licence (LPPL) 1.3c or later; copyright 2025–2026 Luca Salvatore. The simil front page reproduces the arrangement of the official Bocconi front page; the Bocconi name and logos belong to Università Bocconi and are not shipped with the package. academicthesis is not published by Università Bocconi: before submitting a thesis, check the current rules of your degree programme.